

Chapter 8 — Attention and Resource Allocation

Field	Value
Status	Revised after whole-book constitutional and cross-chapter audit
Version	0.3
Scope	Allocate finite physical, financial, cognitive and human-attention resources according to constitutional responsibility, risk and Owner intent.
Constitutional basis	Decisions 18, 21, 28–29, 41, 46, 54, 57
Owner review	No unresolved Owner decision after whole-book audit

1. Purpose

Allocate finite physical, financial, cognitive and human-attention resources according to constitutional responsibility, risk and Owner intent.

2. Authoritative Responsibilities

Component	Authoritative responsibility
Attention Manager	Attention Objects, focus modes, interruption decisions and history
Resource Governor	Budgets, reservations, admission control, quality of service and emergency reserve
Scheduler	Policy-constrained assignment across feasible nodes and providers
Meta-Attention Reviewer	Starvation, neglected obligations and recurring blind spots

3. Core State and Records

Object	Required content
Attention Object	Subject, urgency, importance, responsibility, risk, confidence, novelty, persistence and Owner interest.
Resource Budget	Resource class, amount, period, owner, hard/soft limit and escalation behavior.
Focus Mode	Normal, Deep Work, Owner Conversation, Emergency, Recovery, Maintenance, Observation or Learning.
Interruption Decision	Reason, affected focus, deferred work, delivery timing and evidence.

4. Runtime Workflow

1. Create or update Attention Objects from requests, incidents, commitments and reflection.
2. Apply hard constitutional, safety, privacy and resource constraints before optimization.
3. Reserve protected capacity for governance, observability and recovery.
4. Allocate remaining capacity using purpose, risk, deadline, locality, reliability and Owner preferences.
5. Record interruption, deferment, resumption and starvation review.
6. Periodically ask what is being overlooked and elevate neglected responsibilities for review.

5. Interfaces and Contracts

All commands, queries and events are typed, versioned, authenticated and correlated. Commands request mutation from the authoritative owner; queries declare consistency and privacy scope; immutable events record completed facts with identity, causation, authorization, provenance and integrity metadata.

6. Failure and Recovery

- Overload: admit constitutional and safety work first; defer optional work visibly.
- Resource exhaustion: preserve recovery reserve and degrade quality or throughput deliberately.
- Attention starvation: age persistent obligations into review without granting automatic execution.
- Emergency mode: reprioritize through explicit policy; do not permanently redefine ordinary priorities.

7. Constitutional Guarantees

- Hard constraints are inviolable; optimization occurs only inside the permitted space.
- No workload may starve constitutional, observability or recovery capacity.
- Attention changes are explainable and significant shifts are retained in Attention History.
- High activity is not success; HAL may correctly allocate attention to monitoring or non-action.

8. Prohibited Behaviors

- No component may silently broaden authority, reinterpret Owner intent, erase dissent, or treat a derived projection as authoritative state.
- No degraded dependency may silently change policy, identity, trust, authentication, verification or evidence requirements.
- No provider, model, node, Presence, secret, relationship or network location receives constitutional authority by implication.

9. Observability and Verification

The subsystem records correlation, identity, policy/authority context, state versions, decisions, limitations, failures, recovery and outcomes. Verification is risk-scaled and produces durable evidence. Status reporting is derived from governed state rather than model assertion.

10. Source Alignment and Review

This chapter directly implements Decisions 18, 21, 28–29, 41, 46, 54, 57. The v0.2 rewrite restores the source-specific objects, workflows and guarantees missing from v0.1. Final disposition is recorded in the separate source-alignment and constitutional-audit reports.

Whole-Book Audit Resolution

The following requirements supersede any ambiguous earlier wording in this chapter and are incorporated into this edition:

- The Chapter 8 Scheduler is the sole authority for work admission and placement.
- Temporal commitments, recurrence, windows, and deadlines are authoritative inputs from Chapter 13; they do not create a second placement authority.